Return to Order of Business

TAB 10

Los Angeles Unified School District

333 South Beaudry Ave,
Los Angeles, CA 90017

Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-080-23/24, **Version:** 1

Ratification of the GATES Foundation R&D Partnership for Math Equity Grant Award
February 13, 2024
Division of Instruction

Action Proposed:
Ratify the Gates Foundation R&D Partnership for Math Equity grant award, in the total amount of $4,500,000, over a three-year period. The grant award began on January 1, 2024, and continues through December 31, 2026.

Background:
Through the Gates Foundation R&D Partnership, staff seeks to conduct analyses and collect data to inform LAUSD about the effectiveness of a digital math tool currently being used to enhance students' math skills. Pursuant to the Gates Foundation grant terms, three partners must work on each research project (a school district, a research team, and a math digital tool provider). The District's project involves the Los Angeles Education Research Institute (UCLA) and IXL.

The Gates Foundation carefully selected math providers, and IXL became a choice due to its capacity for personalization and its current adoption among middle and high school students. IXL is a research-based digital platform that has been shown to have a positive impact on student learning. Usage of the IXL platform will help support students' i-Ready and SBA growth metrics.

This initiative aligns with our 2022-26 Strategic Plan which centers on our Core Beliefs-Equity, Collaboration, and Excellence and increases our capacity to prepare all students for success in postsecondary education and the workforce. Approximately 45 schools will participate in the research project. Schools with a high percentage of at-promise students (e.g., low income, foster care, and Emergent Bilinguals) will be prioritized and selected based upon their IXL usage rates (e.g., high, medium, or low). The final selection of schools will be completed by the end of February.

Expected Outcomes:
Improve students' knowledge and understanding of mathematical concepts through the consistent use of IXL.

To support these outcomes, we will:

- examine students' use of IXL;
- determine if IXL usage is related to mathematical learning, engagement, and motivation;
- implement and refine professional development focused on integrating IXL into instruction;
- evaluate the relationship between IXL usage and students' learning, engagement, motivation, and persistence in mathematics;
- implement and refine various approaches to encouraging students to use IXL during non-instructional breaks.

Through this research initiative, we anticipate that the District will gain improved insights into:

- providing professional development opportunities for the integration of digital tools, such as IXL, to elevate instructional practices and enhance proficiency in mathematics;
- identifying cost-effective strategies to promote the utilization of digital math tools among students during non-instructional breaks.

The research will do the following to develop a data infrastructure that is useful for practice:

- conduct quantitative analyses to identify and/or construct IXL usage indicators that are associated with student learning, engagement, motivation, and persistence;
- build a data portal that can provide access to those measures.

The establishment of this data infrastructure is poised to grant LAUSD administrators and coordinators access to targeted metrics crucial for swift-cycle improvement research. Furthermore, it is anticipated that educators from selected schools will participate in up to three virtual professional development sessions per school, with additional sessions tailored to their specific requirements. These sessions will focus on integrating IXL into their instructional methods. Additionally, an estimated 15,000 students from the selected schools will be prompted to utilize IXL during the summer break.

Board Options and Consequences:
The Board has the option of voting “Yes” to receive these funds or voting “No” to decline these funds.

If the Board votes “No”, the District would forgo an opportunity to enhance its ability to learn how to use the digital learning tools more effectively, particularly IXL, which is part of the District’s multi-tiered system of support and intended to help students improve their achievement.

A “Yes” vote would make it possible for the District to: 1) develop a better understanding of how to train teachers to use digital learning tools effectively for Tier 2 and Tier 3 instruction; 2) understand whether there are cost effective ways to encourage students to use digital learning tools during the non-instructional breaks, and 3) gain access to data that are useful for rapid-cycle improvement research and longer-cycle efficacy evaluation research.

Policy Implications:
There are no policy implications.

Budget Impact:
The funds provided by the Gates Foundation will cover all expenses related to the project.

Student Impact:
The interventions we plan to implement and the research we plan to conduct will improve the District’s understanding of how to encourage the effective use of digital math tools during the school year and the summer so that students improve their math knowledge, conceptual understanding, and engagement. The grant will also develop an IXL data infrastructure that will facilitate access to data that will be useful for internal and external research. The knowledge gained from this project will support the District’s efforts to improve students’ math performance and their subsequent postsecondary and workforce success.

Equity Impact:

Component	Score	Score Rationale
Recognition	**3**	This grant affirmatively recognizes historical inequities by focusing on fostering math learning, motivation, and engagement among Black, Latinx, and low-income students.
Resource Prioritization	**4**	This grant effectively prioritizes resources based on student need by specifically targeting schools that serve large populations of historically marginalized students.
Results	**3**	The grant is likely to result in closing achievement gaps because the funds will be used to implement and evaluate strategies for using digital tools to improve math knowledge, conceptual understanding, and engagement among Black, Latinx, and low-income students.
TOTAL	**10**	

Issues and Analysis:
None

Attachments:
Attachment A - Budget

Linked Material reference under background 2022-26 Strategic Plan <https://www.lausd.org/cms/lib/CA01000043/Centricity/Domain/1371/22-26_Strategic_Plan-1122.pdf>

Informatives:
None

Submitted:
01/30/24

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RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,

ALBERTO M. CARVALHO
Superintendent

APPROVED BY:

KARLA V. ESTRADA
Deputy Superintendent of Instruction

REVIEWED BY:

DEVORA NAVERA REED
General Counsel

✓ Approved as to form.

APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:

FRANCES BAEZ
Chief Academic Officer
Division of Instruction

REVIEWED BY:

NOLBERTO DELGADILLO
Deputy Chief Business Officer, Finance

✓ Approved as to budget impact statement.

APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:

JOHN VLADOVIC
Executive Director
Division of Instruction

ATTACHMENT A

Budget: Gates R&D Partnership for Math Equity Grant

Description	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Total Grant Distribution
DOI Administrative support(X time)for PDs	$11,246	$12,426	$13,731	
ODA Administrative support (X time)	$3,878	$4,285	$4,735	
District Project Leader (A Basis Admin)	$227,803	$251,722	$278,153	
Clerical Support	$6,049	$6,685	$4,924	
Teacher PD Coaches/Assistants	$7,411	$8,576	$7,668	
Mileage	$1,905	$2,239	$2,239	
Conference	$7,440		$8,000	
General Supplies	$5,000			
Teacher PD X	$46,563	$44,990		
Administrator PD X	$2,392	$1,579		
Teacher X time for intervention		$119,459	$119,459	
Administrator X time for intervention		$5,491	$6,491	
Training rate for Teachers and Administrators	$4,240	$5,300	$5,300	
Incentives for students to participate		$135,393	$132,880	$1,505,652
UCLA Research Team	$610,653	$504,972	$532,619	$1,648,244
IXL	$732,951	$489,111	$124,072	$1,346,134
Total	$1,667,531	$1,592,228	$1,240,271	$4,500,030